Website Accessibility Check: pass-christian.com

Prepared for City of Pass Christian, Office of the City Clerk · Pass Christian, MS

Under the Department of Justice's ADA Title II web rule, cities with fewer than 50,000 residents must make their websites, and the documents posted on them, meet the WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standard by April 26, 2028. On November 2, 2026 I ran an automated WCAG 2.1 AA check on three pages of pass-christian.com (Home, Forms and Contact) and sampled the PDF forms. Automated tools catch only part of what a full review covers, so treat this as a starting list, not a complete audit.

FIX

1. Menu text is hard to read

The gray-green text in the main menu sits on a light teal background at a contrast of 3.32 to 1. The standard requires at least 4.5 to 1 for normal text. This shows up on every page: 17 items on the home page, 67 on Forms and 23 on Contact.

Darken the menu text color (or lighten the background) in the theme settings. This is one change that fixes it site-wide.

FIX

2. PDF forms may not be readable by screen readers

The Forms page links 56 PDFs. In a sample of 20, only 3 showed the accessibility tags screen readers rely on, and several appear to be scanned images with no readable text. Forms residents use to apply for permits or services are covered by the rule.

Rebuild the most-used forms as tagged, fillable PDFs or web forms, starting with permits, water billing and business licenses.

FIX

3. No main heading on the home page

The home page has no top-level (H1) heading. Screen reader users jump between headings to find their way, and the page gives them no starting point.

Mark the page title, such as "City of Pass Christian," as the H1.

FIX

4. No "skip to main content" link

None of the pages checked has a skip link, so someone using only a keyboard has to tab through the full menu on every page before reaching the content.

Add a skip link at the top of the site template. It stays hidden until a keyboard user tabs to it.

FIX

5. A link with no name

Each page checked has one icon link with no text or label, so a screen reader reads it as just "link." One image on the home page is also missing its description (alt text).

Add a short label to the icon link and alt text to the image.

GOOD

6. Page language and contact form

The site declares its language correctly, most images have descriptions, and the contact form fields passed the automated label check.

Plenty of time to fix this, if it starts soon.

I'm Josh Biehl, a veteran-owned web developer here in Pass Christian. Coastline Code can fix the site-wide items above in the theme and work through the forms well ahead of the 2028 deadline, with a written record of what was checked and fixed. I'm glad to walk through this in person at City Hall. Call or text (228) 304-5333 or email info@coastlinecode.com.